



Brand & Design System

Makeup advice that finally has *your* face in mind. Neu removes the default.

VERSION 1.0

JULY 2026

NEU — IOS

1 • The product

Neu is an iOS app. A **30-second quiz** — no camera, no photos — places you on the **Monk Skin Tone Scale** and works out your undertone, **including olive**, which most tools pretend does not exist. From then on the whole app is filtered through people who share your tone: your **tone twins**. Their foundation that didn't oxidize, their SPF that left no cast, their blush that didn't go muddy. You arrive, you see what works on skin like yours, and eventually you post what works on you.

Two things the brand never confuses

- **Undertone** — a property of *you*. The hue beneath your surface colour: warm, cool, neutral, or olive. Permanent.
- **Cast** — a flaw of a *product*. The tint it leaves behind on you: white flashback, grey/ashy, oxidized orange, pink pull. This is what tone-twin verdicts flag.

2 • Voice & content

Girl to girl. Warm, direct, a little conspiratorial — a friend who actually knows her stuff. Confident, never clinical, never preachy.

RULE	HOW NEU DOES IT
Person	Second person, always — "what works on skin like yours", "your tone twins". Neu says "we" warmly and rarely.
Casing	Sentence case everywhere. UPPERCASE only for small mono eyebrows (YOUR UNDERTONE).
Specificity	Name the exact failure mode: "didn't oxidize", "no white cast", "didn't go muddy", "no grey cast".
Numbers	Always tied to people: "1,240 tone twins share MST-07 olive"; "87% wear 310–330".
Length	Short. One editorial line for headlines, 1–2 sentences of body. Punchy over thorough.
Emoji	Never. Warmth comes from voice and type, not emoji.

WE SAY

skin like yours · your tone twins · we worked out
your undertone · didn't oxidize on her

NEVER

flattering for all skin types · universally beautiful
· one-size-fits-all · suits everyone

3 • Logo

The mark is Neu's own. Use the supplied files — never redraw, recolour, or rebuild it. Minimum clear space on all sides equals the height of the mark's inner shape; minimum size 24 px for the icon, 96 px wide for the lockup.



FILE	USE
assets/logo.svg	Primary lockup — light backgrounds
assets/logo-reversed.svg	Reversed lockup — black / dark backgrounds
assets/logomark.svg	Mark alone — avatars, favicons, tight spaces
assets/neu-icon.svg · neu-icon-dark.svg	App icon, light and dark
assets/neu-icon-mono-light.svg · -mono-dark.svg	Single-colour icon for tinted / monochrome contexts

4 • Typography

One geometric family carries the brand. Display and body share it — display just runs heavier and tighter. Mono is reserved for tone codes and uppercase labels.

ROLE	FAMILY	NOTES
Display	Circular Corner Medium	Headlines, screen titles. Tracking -0.03em.
Body / UI	Circular Corner	All interface and reading copy. Tracking 0.
Mono	Space Mono	Tone codes (MST-07), uppercase eyebrows. Tracking 0.08em.

Font licensing. Circular Corner Medium is the named brand face and is not bundled with this system. Until the licensed files are installed, the stack falls back to **Poppins**.

Approved substitutes, in order: **Circular Std** · **Avenir Next** · **Sofia Pro** · **Nunito Sans**.

Type scale

TOKEN	SIZE	SPECIMEN
--t-display	52px	Removes the default
--t-h1	36px	Your tone twins
--t-h2	27px	What works on skin like yours
--t-h3	21px	Foundation that didn't oxidize
--t-title	17px	Nav & row titles
--t-body	16px	A 30-second quiz, no camera.
--t-sm / --t-cap	14 / 13px	Secondary copy and captions
--t-micro	11px	MST-07 · OLIVE

Line heights: --lh-tight 1.04 · --lh-head 1.14 · --lh-body 1.5 · --lh-relaxed 1.62. Weights: 400 / 500 / 600 / 700.

5 • Colour

Backgrounds are **locked**: pure white in light mode, true black in dark mode — no exceptions. Amethyst is the trust signal and the only colour that carries primary action.

Light mode — neutrals

TOKEN	HEX	USE
 --paper	#FFFFFF	App background — locked white
 --paper-sink	#F6F4F9	Recessed / grouped background
 --surface-2	#FAF8FC	Subtle raised surface
 --line	#ECEAF1	Hairline borders
 --line-strong	#DBD6E4	Stronger borders, inputs
 --ink	#2E2440	Primary text — aubergine
 --ink-2	#655A7C	Secondary text
 --ink-3	#A99CC0	Tertiary / captions

Brand hues

TOKEN	HEX	USE
 --amethyst	#7C6A99	Signature — trust signal, primary CTA
 --amethyst-deep	#4E4562	Pressed state, links
 --amethyst-soft	#EEE9F4	Tint surface, verdict pills
 --lilac	#AB92BF	Soft supporting tint
 --berry	#C75C86	Beauty / blush cue, highlight
 --gold	#C08552	Warm caramel — spark accent, warnings

Dark mode

Neutrals go true black and aubergine; amethyst lifts to a brighter lilac so the signal and the glass stay crisp. Every semantic alias re-points automatically — components need no changes.

TOKEN	HEX	USE
 --paper	#000000	App background — locked black
 --surface	#141019	Raised cards — aubergine black
 --line	#2A2434	Hairline borders
 --ink	#F1EDF6	Primary text
 --ink-2	#B6ACC6	Secondary text
 --amethyst	#B79ED6	Signature, brightened for black
 --berry	#E58AAC	Blush cue, lifted
 --gold	#E0AC72	Caramel accent, lifted

Semantic aliases

Build against these, not the raw hues — they resolve correctly in both modes.

--bg · --bg-grouped · --text · --text-muted · --text-faint · --border · --action
· --action-press · --action-text · --action-quiet · --link · --link-hover ·
-accent · --highlight · --good · --good-soft · --warn · --bad · --ring

6 · Skin-tone system

The Monk Skin Tone Scale is the app's spine and a first-class part of the palette. The ten values are the official scale and are **fixed across light and dark mode** — skin does not re-theme.

TOKEN	HEX	TOKEN	HEX
 --mst-1	#F6EDE4	 --mst-6	#A07E56
 --mst-2	#F3E7DB	 --mst-7	#825C43
 --mst-3	#F7EAD0	 --mst-8	#604134
 --mst-4	#EADABA	 --mst-9	#3A312A
 --mst-5	#D7BD96	 --mst-10	#292420

Undertone chips — a property of you

	TOKEN	HEX	READS AS
	--tone-warm	#E6A867	Golden / peach cast; gold jewellery flatters; tans easily
	--tone-cool	#D298A6	Pink / rosy cast; silver flatters; burns then pinks
	--tone-neutral	#D0BEA2	Balanced beige; no strong lean either way
	--tone-olive	#9B9C6E	Green-grey cast over warm — the one most tools ignore

Wrist-vein cues — the quiz's physical test

	TOKEN	HEX	POINTS TO
	--vein-blue	#3F6FB0	Cool
	--vein-purple	#A98CC6	Cool
	--vein-teal	#4F9E9A	Neutral (blue-green)
	--vein-green	#6F9E88	Warm
	--vein-olive	#8A9A6B	Olive / warm-leaning

Product cast cues — a flaw of the product

	TOKEN	HEX	VERDICT IT ILLUSTRATES
	--cast-white	#EFEAE4	SPF flashback / white cast
	--cast-grey	#9A9488	Ashy / grey cast
	--cast-orange	#C87A44	Oxidized / turned orange
	--cast-pink	#D69AA6	Pink pull

7 • Space, shape & depth

Spacing — 4pt base rhythm

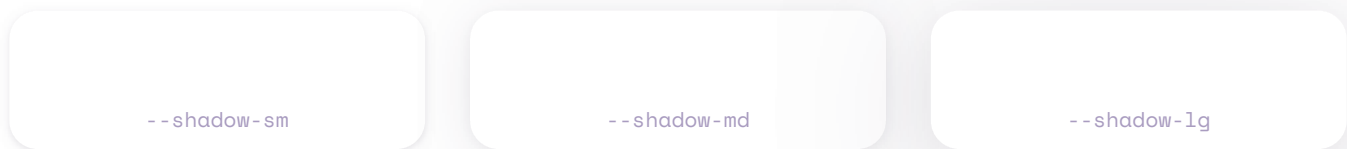
`--sp-1 4 · --sp-2 8 · --sp-3 12 · --sp-4 16 · --sp-5 20 · --sp-6 24 · --sp-7 32 · --sp-8 40 · --sp-9 56 · --sp-10 72` px. Screen gutters 20–22 px; card inner padding 16–20 px. Design width `--w-screen 390px`.

Corner radii — soft, never bubbly



Cards use `--r-lg`; inputs and tiles `--r-md`; buttons and chips are full pills. Tone dots are circles.

Elevation — soft and low



Shadows are amethyst-tinted, never neutral grey. Nothing floats hard. Focus uses `--ring` rather than a heavy border.

Glass

Frosted surfaces are reserved for chrome — tab bars, sheets, floating overlays — never for reading surfaces. Tokens: `--glass`, `--glass-strong`, `--glass-border`, `--glass-highlight`, `--glass-shadow`, `--glass-blur (18px)`, and `--aurora`, the faint tinted wash that gives glass something to refract against.

8 · Motion & states

STATE	BEHAVIOUR
Transitions	120–180 ms ease on colour and background. Restrained; no bounces, no showy motion.
Hover (web)	Slight darken or tint. Never a size change.
Press	Buttons scale to 0.97. Options fill with their tint.
Selected	Amethyst ring plus soft fill for quiz options; solid ink fill for chips.
Focus	--ring — a 3px amethyst halo.
Disabled	45% opacity, no colour change.

9 • Iconography & imagery

Icons: Lucide, 2px stroke, loaded from CDN. 22 px in the tab bar, 16–20 px inline. Icons inherit `currentColor`; active nav is amethyst, resting is `--ink-3`. Functional only — never decorative filler. Emoji are never used as icons; the two deliberate glyph exceptions are the heart save toggle (♥/♡) and the check on selected options (✓).

Imagery: warm, skin-forward, no cool or blue cast, no black-and-white, no heavy grain. Product imagery uses soft two-stop tonal gradients rather than stock photography. Profile pictures are real photos, circular, with the member's Monk-tone dot at the corner.

10 • Components

Available on `window.NeuDesignSystem_32f7fb` after loading `_ds_bundle.js`.

GROUP	COMPONENT	WHAT IT'S FOR
forms	Button	Pill CTA — primary / quiet / soft / ghost, three sizes
	Chip	Selectable filter or tone pill, optional colour dot
	Input	Text / search field with amethyst focus ring
	SegmentedControl	iOS-style view switcher
	QuizOption	Large tappable quiz answer
display	Card	Base surface — rounded, hairline border, soft shadow
	ProductCard	A product seen through tone twins — the feed's heart
	Badge	Verdict / status pill
	Avatar	Tone twin, with corner Monk-tone dot
	ToneSwatch	Monk-tone dot with placement ring — signature primitive
navigation	TabBar	iOS bottom nav, glass blur

11 • Files

PATH	CONTENTS
styles.css	Global entry point — link this one file
tokens/	colors · typography · spacing · radius · shadow · glass · fonts
assets/	Logo lockups, mark, app icons (light / dark / mono)
guidelines/	Foundation specimen cards and this guide
components/	forms · display · navigation — JSX, typings, prompts
ui_kits/neu-app/	Interactive iOS app recreation
wireframes/	App flow wireframes
readme.md · SKILL.md	Design guide and Agent-Skill wrapper

12 • Open items

- **Circular Corner Medium** — licensed files not yet installed; Poppins renders in the meantime.
- **Undertone chip visuals** — chips are parked in the UI pending a later pass; the tokens remain in the system.